THE HOUSE OF IDEAS

CHAPTER FIVE

“I AM IRON MAN”

April 30 – May 5, 2008
Los Angeles, California

An Alternate-History Hollywood Saga

COLD OPEN - NINE MONTHS IN HEADLINES

VARIETY - NOVEMBER 5, 2007

WRITERS STRIKE: SCRIBES WALK OUT; HOLLYWOOD BRACES FOR LONG FIGHT

"Iron Man" and "The Incredible Hulk" already wrapped and are largely insulated; Marvel's future slate faces delays.

THE HOLLYWOOD REPORTER - FEBRUARY 13, 2008

STRIKE OVER: WGA MEMBERS RATIFY DEAL AFTER 100 DAYS

ENTERTAINMENT WEEKLY - APRIL 2008 - "SUMMER MOVIE PREVIEW"

THE BIG GAMBLE: Can a former Donohue Channel kid open a $140 million superhero movie?

"Tracking is through the roof," says one rival executive. "Which terrifies me."

FADE IN:

EXT. GRAUMAN'S CHINESE THEATRE - HOLLYWOOD BOULEVARD - NIGHT

SUPER: WEDNESDAY, APRIL 30, 2008 - 6:45 P.M. PDT - THE IRON MAN PREMIERE

Hollywood Boulevard is shut down. A thirty-foot replica of the MARK III armor stands in the forecourt, glowing red and gold beside the handprints of movie legends. Searchlights sweep the sky. Thousands of fans crowd behind barricades, many in homemade armor. The red carpet is a wall of flashbulbs.

On the carpet, an E! NEWS CORRESPONDENT (30s) holds a microphone toward MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (26), in a black Tom Ford tux, an arc-reactor-shaped pin glowing faintly on his lapel.

E! CORRESPONDENT
Marc-Anthony, eighteen months ago people said Marvel was crazy to cast you. How does it feel tonight?

MARC-ANTHONY
Honestly? It feels like I'm about to find out if they were right.

(grinning)
Ask me again at midnight.

Down the carpet: TAYIA BOYD (26) in red, posing beside TERRENCE HOWARD (39). JEFF BRIDGES (58), his hair grown back, wears a T-shirt under his tux jacket that says "IRON MONGER FOR PRESIDENT." STAN LEE (85) waves to the fans like a returning king.

Then the cameras turn as one. A gasp from the press line.

PHOTOGRAPHER
It's Victor Donohue! Victor! Over here!

VICTOR DONOHUE (71) steps out of a black Maybach with JOAN DONOHUE (70) on his arm, followed by NATASHA (46) and ROBERT BULLOCK (49), ELXA (27) and GRACE (14). The chairman of Donohue Entertainment, at a premiere for a Paramount-distributed Marvel film. Every photographer on the boulevard loses their mind.

ACCESS HOLLYWOOD CORRESPONDENT
Mr. Donohue! Your company doesn't distribute this film. Why are you here?

VICTOR
(calm, regal)
Because my grandson is in it, young man. I'd go to the moon for that.

ACCESS HOLLYWOOD CORRESPONDENT
And your granddaughter, Elxa?

VICTOR
(a small, proud smile)
She's in it too. She tells me she's "only thirty seconds." I tell her Bette Davis could do a lot with thirty seconds.

Elxa blushes. Grace, in a sparkly dress, is taking photos of everything on a pink digital camera.

GRACE
(to Marc, whispering)
Grandpa just said "Bette Davis" on E! News. Who even is that?

MARC-ANTHONY
Someone very famous you should Google.

GRACE
I'll Google her right after I Google how famous you are tonight.

KEVIN FEIGE (34) stands at the end of the carpet with LENORA HAYES (43), both looking like they haven't slept in a week.

LENORA
Tracking says ninety million. Paramount says eighty-five, to be safe. Merrill Lynch says if it's under seventy, they want to "have a conversation."

FEIGE
And what do you say?

LENORA
(watching the crowd scream for Marc)
I say I've never seen a crowd like this for a movie nobody's seen yet.

JON FAVREAU (41) jogs up, out of breath.

FAVREAU
They're seating. Kevin. Did we tell the projectionist? About the end?

FEIGE
He knows. Nobody leaves until the lights come all the way up. Nobody.

CUT TO:

INT. GRAUMAN'S CHINESE THEATRE - AUDITORIUM - NIGHT

SUPER: WEDNESDAY, APRIL 30, 2008 - 9:28 P.M. PDT

The final scene. On screen: a press conference at Stark Industries. Tony Stark at the podium, cue cards in hand, Agent Coulson's cover story in front of him. Rhodey beside him. Pepper watching from the side.

MARC-ANTHONY (ON SCREEN, AS TONY)
I've been told to read this exactly as written. Which, if you know me, is already suspicious.

REPORTER (ON SCREEN)
Mr. Stark, were you the armored figure seen over Gulmira?

MARC-ANTHONY (ON SCREEN, AS TONY)
Me? Flying around in a suit? Do I look like a man who exercises?

He glances at the cue cards. Looks at Rhodey. Looks at the cards. A beat. He puts them down.

MARC-ANTHONY (ON SCREEN, AS TONY) (CONT'D)
The truth is...

A long pause. Marc's face fills the screen: the kid from KID MAYOR, the man from the cave, everything at once.

MARC-ANTHONY (ON SCREEN, AS TONY) (CONT'D)
...I am Iron Man.

The screen SMASHES to black. AC/DC's "Back in Black" kicks in, deafening.

The audience EXPLODES. A wall of sound: screaming, stomping, applause that drowns out the music. People leap to their feet.

In the center section, Marc-Anthony sits frozen, his hand over his mouth. Tayia grabs his arm. Terrence pounds his back. Two rows behind, Victor Donohue is on his feet applauding, a man who has not stood for a standing ovation since 1977.

GRACE
(screaming over the noise, standing on her seat)
HE SAID IT! HE SAID IT! MY BROTHER SAID IT!

Natasha, beside her, is crying openly. Robert holds her hand, his director's eye still on the screen.

ROBERT
(to Natasha, quietly amazed)
That line wasn't in the script, Tasha. Jon told me. He made it up on the day.

NATASHA
(laughing through tears)
Of course he did. He's never followed a script in his life.

CUT TO:

INT. GRAUMAN'S CHINESE THEATRE - AUDITORIUM - LATER

SUPER: WEDNESDAY, APRIL 30, 2008 - 9:36 P.M. PDT

The credits are rolling. Some of the audience is getting up. Feige stands at the side aisle, waving his arms.

FEIGE
(calling out, smiling)
Stay in your seats, please! Everybody! Stay!

The credits end. Black screen. Then: TONY'S MALIBU MANSION, night. Tony walks into his living room. A voice comes out of the dark.

NICK FURY (ON SCREEN)
Four words on live television. Bold. Stupid, but bold.

Tony spins. In the shadows by the window: a tall man in a long black leather coat. An eyepatch. SAMUEL L. JACKSON.

NICK FURY (ON SCREEN) (CONT'D)
You really thought you were the only one out there, Stark? The world just got a whole lot bigger. You're just the last to find out.

MARC-ANTHONY (ON SCREEN, AS TONY)
And you are...?

NICK FURY (ON SCREEN)
Nick Fury. S.H.I.E.L.D.

(beat)
We need to talk about the Avengers Initiative.

Black. Then the words: "TONY STARK WILL RETURN."

Two seconds of stunned silence. Then the theater ERUPTS, louder than before. A man in the back literally falls over a seat. Someone screams "SAM JACKSON!" Stan Lee is on his feet pumping his fist in the air.

Elxa turns to her brother, eyes wide.

ELXA
(whispering)
He said Avengers. On screen. Out loud.

MARC-ANTHONY
(whispering back)
I know. I was standing right there when he said it. I had to pretend I didn't know who he was. Hardest acting I've ever done.

Across the aisle, Feige leans against the wall and closes his eyes. Lenora stands beside him.

LENORA
You realize that tomorrow there is no going back. You just promised the world the Avengers.

FEIGE
(eyes still closed, smiling)
I promised the world the comics, Lenora. The Avengers were always in the comics.

CUT TO:

INT. MANN VILLAGE THEATRE - WESTWOOD - NIGHT

SUPER: THURSDAY, MAY 1, 2008 - 8:00 P.M. PDT - FIRST PUBLIC SHOWING

A packed preview screening. The SUPERHERO HYPE CREW are in the third row, back together. GARY MORRIS (42), in a brand new IRON MAN shirt. PRIYA SHAH (23), in her Wasp hoodie, now with a gold brooch pinned to it. DARNELL JOHNSON (30), and TOMMY REYES (20), with a giant Coke.

GARY
Eighteen months. Eighteen months I've waited to find out if I was wrong about the Kid Mayor.

DARNELL
You already know you were wrong. You watched the trailer six hundred times.

GARY
Trailers lie. The movie doesn't lie.

PRIYA
Stay after the credits. Everyone on the boards says stay. Somebody's cousin's friend at the premiere said "don't leave, whatever you do."

The lights go down. The Marvel logo flips across the screen to a guitar riff. The theater cheers.

INT. MANN VILLAGE THEATRE - LATER

SUPER: THURSDAY, MAY 1, 2008 - 10:01 P.M. PDT

The "I am Iron Man" moment. The screen cuts to black. The theater DETONATES. Gary is on his feet, both fists in the air, tears streaming down his face.

GARY
(screaming)
HE TOLD THEM! HE TOLD THEM! IT'S 2002, IRON MAN #55! TONY TELLS THE WORLD IN THE COMICS TOO! THEY DID IT! THEY ACTUALLY DID IT!

TOMMY
Gary, sit down, people are staring!

GARY
LET THEM STARE!

A minute later: the post-credits scene. Nick Fury steps out of the shadows. "The Avengers Initiative." Priya SCREAMS so loudly the projectionist checks the booth window. She grabs Darnell by both shoulders.

PRIYA
AVENGERS! HE SAID IT! FEIGE TOLD ME TO READ AVENGERS #1 AND HE MEANT IT! HE MEANT IT!

DARNELL
(stunned, quietly)
Ultimate Nick Fury. Sam Jackson's face, like they drew him in 2002. They got Sam Jackson.

Tommy just sits there, his Coke forgotten, mouth open.

TOMMY
Bro. Hulk is next month. The Hulk is in this universe. Ant-Man is in this universe. The Wasp was at the PARTY. They're all in the same universe.

The four of them look at each other in the flickering light of the empty screen as the rest of the theater files out, buzzing.

GARY
(hoarse, quiet)
They kept the promise. Every bolt. Every line. Obadiah's bald. Yinsen's named Yinsen. The Mark I looks like Kirby drew it. Nobody got nerfed. They actually kept it.

CUT TO:

MONTAGE - THE INTERNET MELTS DOWN

SUPER: THURSDAY, MAY 1, 2008 - 10:15 P.M. TO FRIDAY, MAY 2 - 3:00 A.M. PDT

SUPERHEROHYPE.COM - THREAD: "OFFICIAL IRON MAN REVIEW THREAD - SPOILERS!!!" (Page 1 of 403)

ShellHead1963 (May 1, 10:22 PM)
I'm posting from the parking lot of the Village in Westwood. I have been on this board for seven years. I wrote 206 posts saying Marc-Anthony Bullock would ruin Iron Man. I was wrong. He IS Tony Stark. I will now post 206 apologies. This is number one.

NoNerfsPlz (May 1, 10:25 PM)
NICK FURY. AVENGERS INITIATIVE. I'm literally crying in Tommy's car. Feige told me to reread Avengers #1 and HE MEANT IT.

WarMachineRox (May 1, 10:31 PM)
Terrence eyeing the silver armor at the end. WAR MACHINE IS COMING. I'm a grown man and I'm screaming in my apartment.

Gamma_Gamma_Hey (May 1, 10:40 PM)
The Iron Monger fight on the PCH is all practical. You can feel the weight. Real metal, real cars. CGI only for the flying. Marvel Method is no joke.

Repulsor_Ray (May 1, 10:52 PM)
"I am Iron Man" is the best ending to a superhero movie in history and I'll fight anybody who says otherwise.

ElektraWasAMistake (May 1, 11:10 PM)
Janet van Dyne's brooch got the biggest cheer at my theater besides the ending. Half the theater knew. The other half was asking "who's the lady??"

Mjolnir_Worthy (May 1, 11:44 PM)
Stan Lee's cameo where Tony calls him Hef. I spit out my soda.

YOUTUBE.COM - "IRON MAN POST CREDIT SCENE REACTION (THEATER GOES CRAZY)" - uploaded by midnight_marvel_mania - 1,204,331 views

Description: shot on my phone sorry. WAIT FOR SAMUEL L JACKSON. the guy in the back FALLS OVER A SEAT at 0:47. AVENGERS CONFIRMED?????

FACEBOOK - STATUS UPDATES

Jordan K. (University of Michigan) is ... SCREENSHOTTING MY CHART FROM LAST JULY. IRON MAN, HULK, ANT-MAN, THOR, CAP, AVENGERS. I CALLED IT. I. CALLED. IT.

Jasmine T. (Howard University) is ... "I am Iron Man." A Black man said that on a movie screen tonight and my whole theater stood up. I'm emotional.

Group: "MARVEL IS SECRETLY MAKING THE AVENGERS (PROOF INSIDE)" has changed its name to "MARVEL IS MAKING THE AVENGERS (CONFIRMED BY NICK FURY)" - 212,804 members

TWITTER.COM - PUBLIC TIMELINE

hallhpriya: HE SAID AVENGERS INITIATIVE. FEIGE YOU BEAUTIFUL MAN. 10:03 PM May 1st from txt

amondbaker: i have seen it 4 times. my best friend is iron man. i am the hulk in 6 weeks. hulk is not allowed to say anything about anything. hulk is in timeout permanently 11:15 PM May 1st from web

tayiaboyd: that ending. that ending. that ENDING. thank you all for coming to see us 11:42 PM May 1st from web

edgarwright: the wasp got a cheer. 14 months of secrecy worth it. ant-man july 31 2009 12:20 AM May 2nd from web

CUT TO:

INT. AMC MAGIC JOHNSON THEATRES - BALDWIN HILLS CRENSHAW PLAZA - NIGHT

SUPER: FRIDAY, MAY 2, 2008 - 7:10 P.M. PDT

A packed Friday night crowd. The audience is mostly Black: families, teenagers, church groups, grandmothers who came because their grandsons wouldn't stop talking about it.

In the back row, slouched down, two women in hoodies and sunglasses: ESTHER SMILLEY (25) and SIMONE SMILLEY (28). Simone holds a giant tub of popcorn. Esther is barely breathing.

SIMONE
(whispering)
Relax. Nobody's going to recognize America's Sweetheart in a Sean John hoodie in the back row of the Magic Johnson.

ESTHER
(whispering)
If Daddy finds out...

SIMONE
Daddy thinks you're at choir rehearsal and I'm at my meeting. Which I already went to this morning, by the way. Eat a Junior Mint.

INT. MAGIC JOHNSON THEATRES - LATER

SUPER: FRIDAY, MAY 2, 2008 - 9:12 P.M. PDT

On screen, the cave. Tony, bleeding, rebuilding his heart. Yinsen dying in his arms.

SHAUN TOUB (ON SCREEN, AS YINSEN)
You have a second chance, Stark. Spend it on something worth saving.

Esther's hand goes to her mouth. A tear rolls under her sunglasses. Simone glances at her little sister, then quietly hands her a napkin.

Later. The press conference. "The truth is..." The theater goes dead silent.

MARC-ANTHONY (ON SCREEN, AS TONY)
...I am Iron Man.

The Magic Johnson Theatre ERUPTS. A GRANDMOTHER (70s) in the second row stands up and shouts:

GRANDMOTHER
THAT'S RIGHT, BABY! YOU TELL 'EM!

Laughter and cheers. A LITTLE BOY (8) in a plastic Iron Man mask stands on his chair, fist in the air. Esther watches him, crying and laughing at the same time.

ESTHER
(barely audible)
He did it, Simone. He really did it.

SIMONE
(watching her sister, not the screen)
Yeah, baby girl. He did.

Simone notices how Esther looks at the screen. It's not how a fan looks at a movie star. It's how a person looks at a person.

SIMONE (CONT'D)
(gently)
Esther. How long have you been in love with him?

Esther freezes. She doesn't answer. She doesn't have to.

SIMONE (CONT'D)
Okay. Okay.

(beat, squeezing her hand)
Don't leave before the credits finish. Apparently there's a thing.

CUT TO:

INT. ARCLIGHT HOLLYWOOD - CINERAMA DOME - NIGHT

SUPER: FRIDAY, MAY 2, 2008 - 10:30 P.M. PDT

A sold-out late show under the giant geodesic dome. The movie has just ended. The credits roll. Most people stay, waiting for the rumored scene.

The post-credits scene plays. Fury. "The Avengers Initiative." The dome shakes with cheers.

As the lights come up, a figure walks onto the small stage in front of the screen with a handheld microphone. Baseball cap, hoodie. He pulls off the cap.

It's MARC-ANTHONY. The audience SCREAMS.

MARC-ANTHONY
(into the mic, grinning)
Hi. Sorry. I know it's late. I just wanted to say thank you. I've been sneaking into theaters all night to watch people watch it. I've been to four. The Grove, the Magic Johnson, Burbank, and now here.

A shout from the crowd: "PUT IT ON MY TAB!"

MARC-ANTHONY (CONT'D)
Tonight, popcorn is on my tab. Just for this theater. The manager already said yes. He's crying a little.

Cheers. A YOUNG WOMAN (19) in the front row raises her hand.

YOUNG WOMAN
Were you at the Magic Johnson? The seven o'clock?

MARC-ANTHONY
For a little bit. I stood in the back and watched the end. There was a grandma in the second row who yelled "You tell 'em, baby." Best review I ever got.

The crowd laughs. Unknown to anyone, five miles away, a woman in the back row of that same theater is still crying.

CUT TO:

DEADLINE HOLLYWOOD DAILY - SATURDAY, MAY 3, 2008, 8:40 AM PT

IRON MAN'S FRIDAY: $36.8M (INCLUDING THURSDAY NIGHT'S $3.9M)! WEEKEND HEADED TO $100M+!!

The numbers are in and Marvel Studios' first self-financed movie is a monster. Exit polls are glowing: CinemaScore "A" across every age group. Paramount execs are telling me they're "in shock." The Rotten Tomatoes score is 94%. This is a phenomenon. And the Donohue Channel kid everybody laughed at? He's the biggest new movie star in America.

CUT TO:

INT. SMILLEY ESTATE - KITCHEN - VIEW PARK - MORNING

SUPER: SATURDAY, MAY 3, 2008 - 9:15 A.M. PDT

Sunlight through the kitchen window. DESMOND SMILLEY (50) sits at the island with the L.A. TIMES Calendar section open in front of him. The headline: "IRON MAN SOARS." He reads it in silence. CELESTE (48) pours coffee. JULIAN (31) wanders in, bleary-eyed.

CELESTE
You were out late last night, Julian.

JULIAN
I was at a friend's.

DESMOND
(not looking up)
Which friend?

Julian hesitates. Then, with the defiance of a grown man finally tired of pretending:

JULIAN
I saw it, Dad. At the Grove. By myself.

Desmond slowly lowers the paper.

JULIAN (CONT'D)
And you know what? He's great. He's really great. He did things in that role I couldn't have done. Not in a hundred years.

DESMOND
(very quiet)
Julian.

JULIAN
No, Dad. Eighteen months I've walked around this house feeling like I lost something that belonged to me. It never belonged to me. It belonged to him. I saw it last night. Everybody in that theater saw it.

He grabs a coffee and walks out. Desmond sits frozen. Celeste puts a hand on his shoulder. He shrugs it off.

Esther comes downstairs in her church clothes, smiling her perfect smile, carrying her jacket.

ESTHER
Good morning, Daddy. Good morning, Mama. I'm going to help set up for the bake sale.

CELESTE
How was choir rehearsal last night, sweetheart?

ESTHER
Long. Pastor Williams made us do the Hallelujah chorus nine times.

She kisses her father on the cheek and heads for the door. Her jacket swings from her arm, and something small flutters out of the pocket onto the floor. She doesn't notice. The door closes behind her.

Desmond looks down at the floor. He bends down slowly and picks it up.

A TICKET STUB. "AMC MAGIC JOHNSON THEATRES - BALDWIN HILLS. IRON MAN (PG-13). FRI 05/02/08. 7:10 PM. ADMIT ONE."

Desmond stares at it for a very long time. Celeste is at the sink, her back turned. She doesn't see.

DESMOND
(barely audible)
...Esther?

CUT TO:

INT. MARC-ANTHONY'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - LOS FELIZ - DAY

SUPER: SUNDAY, MAY 4, 2008 - 10:45 A.M. PDT

The house is full: Amond, Tayia, Elxa, Grace, David Tipton, and Terrence Howard, who brought his guitar. Bagels everywhere. Everyone is staring at Marc's phone on the coffee table, on speaker.

FEIGE (V.O.)
Are you sitting down?

MARC-ANTHONY
Everybody is sitting down, Kevin. Grace is sitting on Amond.

GRACE
He's very comfortable.

AMOND
I'm the Hulk, I can take it.

FEIGE (V.O.)
Paramount's Sunday estimate. Friday thirty-six point eight. Saturday thirty-five. Sunday projecting thirty-two point five.

DAVID
(instantly, the computer guy)
That's one hundred and four point three million dollars.

FEIGE (V.O.)
One hundred and four point three million dollars. The second-biggest opening ever for a movie that isn't a sequel, behind only Spider-Man. And one hundred and ninety-eight million worldwide.

The room explodes. Tayia screams. Terrence plays a triumphant chord. Grace falls off Amond. Elxa throws her arms around her brother.

FEIGE (V.O.) (CONT'D)
Marc? Marc, you there?

MARC-ANTHONY
(overwhelmed, voice thick)
I'm here, Kevin.

FEIGE (V.O.)
I just got off the phone with Merrill Lynch. They don't want to "have a conversation" anymore. They said, and I quote, "Please make more."

(a pause, then softer)
You know what the headline on IGN is this morning? "Marvel Kept Its Promise." That's it. That's the whole headline.

MARC-ANTHONY
We kept it, Kevin. Everybody did.

FEIGE (V.O.)
Nobody got nerfed.

MARC-ANTHONY
Nobody got nerfed.

Click. Silence for a beat. Then Amond grabs Marc in a bear hug and lifts him off the ground.

AMOND
IRON MAN! IRON MAN! IRON MAN!

The whole room chants. Marc-Anthony's phone buzzes on the table. He sees the name and picks it up, stepping away toward the kitchen. Elxa notices.

TEXT MESSAGE - "PASTOR WILLIAMS" TO MARC

SUN 5/4/08 10:52 AM

104 million!!!! i saw it friday at the magic johnson. a grandma yelled "you tell em baby" and i cried in my hoodie. ur sister is a star. ur a star. im so proud of u i could burst

Marc-Anthony stops in the middle of the kitchen.

TEXT MESSAGE - MARC TO "PASTOR WILLIAMS"

SUN 5/4/08 10:53 AM

wait. u were at the magic johnson at 7:10? i was THERE. i stood in the back for the ending. i heard the grandma too

TEXT MESSAGE - "PASTOR WILLIAMS" TO MARC

SUN 5/4/08 10:54 AM

we were in the same room?? and didnt know??

TEXT MESSAGE - MARC TO "PASTOR WILLIAMS"

SUN 5/4/08 10:55 AM

story of our lives

Marc-Anthony stares at those four words on the tiny screen. In the living room, everyone is still chanting his name. He doesn't hear any of it.

CUT TO:

INT. SMILLEY ESTATE - DESMOND'S STUDY - VIEW PARK - DAY

SUPER: SUNDAY, MAY 4, 2008 - 11:00 A.M. PDT

Desmond sits alone at his desk. In front of him: the ticket stub, perfectly flat under the lamp. Beside it, the family portrait. Esther at the center, smiling.

He picks up the phone. Dials. It rings once.

RUSS (V.O.)
Kessler.

DESMOND
(very calm, very cold)
Russ. You can stop following Simone.

RUSS (V.O.)
And?

Desmond looks at the ticket stub. At the photo. At his perfect daughter.

DESMOND
Start following Esther.

SMASH CUT TO BLACK.

MONDAY HEADLINES

SUPER: MONDAY, MAY 5, 2008

VARIETY - MON MAY 5, 2008

'IRON' FIST: MARVEL'S FIRST SELF-FINANCED PIC OPENS TO $104.3M

Second-biggest non-sequel opening ever; Bullock becomes the industry's newest leading man; "A" CinemaScore signals long legs.

THE HOLLYWOOD REPORTER - MON MAY 5, 2008

MARVEL KEPT ITS PROMISE: HOW "NOBODY GETS NERFED" BECAME HOLLYWOOD'S NEW BLUEPRINT

Rival studios scramble to reassess their comic-book franchises after audiences embrace a film that's faithful to the source material.

IGN.COM - FRONT PAGE

MARVEL KEPT ITS PROMISE

Our verdict: 9.5/10. "Iron Man isn't just the best Marvel movie ever made. It's the most faithful comic book movie ever made."

USA TODAY - LIFE - MON MAY 5, 2008

"I am Iron Man": Four words that launched a universe

Plus: What did that post-credits scene mean? A fan's guide to Nick Fury and the Avengers.

THE NEW YORK TIMES - ARTS - MON MAY 5, 2008

A Child Star Grows Up, In Armor

Marc-Anthony Bullock's performance is the rare superhero turn that feels like a real man discovering his conscience. That the man was once a Donohue Channel mayor only deepens the effect.

WALL STREET JOURNAL - MARKETS - MON MAY 5, 2008

Marvel Entertainment (MVL) jumps 9% on "Iron Man" haul; analysts upgrade the stock as Merrill Lynch deal looks like a masterstroke.

JET MAGAZINE - COVER STORY (Issue of May 26, 2008)

MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK: "I AM IRON MAN"

Inside the record-breaking weekend, the Donohue family premiere, and the one question everyone in Black Hollywood is asking: What does View Park think?

FADE OUT.

END OF CHAPTER FIVE